

CONTOSO CORP

Code of Conduct & Ethics Policy

Human Resources Division | Effective: January 1, 2024

Policy ID	CON-HR-001	Effective Date	January 1, 2024
Last Reviewed	December 2023	Policy Owner	Chief People Officer

1. Purpose and Scope

This Code of Conduct and Ethics Policy ("Code") establishes the standards of professional behavior expected of all Contoso Corp employees, contractors, and agents worldwide. Contoso Corp is committed to conducting business with integrity, transparency, and respect for all individuals. This Code applies to every person acting on behalf of Contoso Corp, regardless of role, tenure, or geography.

2. Core Values

Integrity: We are honest, transparent, and accountable in everything we do. We do not misrepresent facts, manipulate data, or act in ways that could mislead stakeholders.

Respect: We treat every individual with dignity regardless of background, identity, or role. Harassment, discrimination, and intimidation have no place at Contoso Corp.

Excellence: We hold ourselves to high professional standards and continuously improve our skills, processes, and outcomes.

Collaboration: We work as one team, sharing knowledge and supporting colleagues to achieve shared goals.

Innovation: We embrace change and encourage creative thinking that drives sustainable value for our clients and stakeholders.

3. Conflicts of Interest

A conflict of interest arises when personal, financial, or other interests could impair — or appear to impair — an employee's ability to act in the best interests of Contoso Corp. Employees must:

- Disclose any actual or potential conflict to their manager and the Ethics & Compliance team within 10 business days of becoming aware of it.
- Recuse themselves from any decision, negotiation, or approval process in which a conflict exists.
- Not use their position to direct Contoso Corp business to entities in which they hold a financial interest.
- Avoid accepting gifts, entertainment, or hospitality exceeding USD 100 in value from a single source per calendar year without prior written approval.

4. Confidential Information & Data Privacy

Employees regularly access information that is proprietary, sensitive, or protected by law. All employees are obligated to:

- Protect confidential business information from unauthorized disclosure, including trade secrets, financial data, client lists, and strategic plans.
- Handle personal data in accordance with the Contoso Corp Data Privacy Policy (CON-IT-004) and applicable laws including GDPR and CCPA.
- Report any suspected or actual data breach to the Information Security team within 24 hours of discovery.
- Return or destroy confidential materials upon termination of employment, per the separation checklist.

5. Anti-Bribery & Anti-Corruption

Contoso Corp prohibits all forms of bribery and corruption. Employees may not offer, promise, give, request, or accept any payment, benefit, or advantage intended to improperly influence a business or government decision. This prohibition applies globally, including in jurisdictions where such practices may be commonplace. Facilitation payments — small unofficial payments to expedite routine government actions — are also prohibited without exception.

6. Workplace Safety & Environment

Contoso Corp is committed to providing a safe, healthy, and environmentally responsible workplace. All employees must comply with applicable health and safety regulations, report unsafe conditions promptly, and participate in required safety training. Threatening behavior, weapons, and substance impairment in the workplace are strictly prohibited.

7. Reporting Violations — Ethics Hotline

Employees who observe or suspect violations of this Code should report them through one of the following channels:

Channel	Contact / URL	Availability
Ethics Hotline (Phone)	1-800-555-0199	24/7, anonymous
Ethics Web Portal	ethics.contosocorp.com	24/7, anonymous option
Direct to Legal/Compliance	compliance@contosocorp.com	Business hours
HR Business Partner	Via employee directory	Business hours

Retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith is strictly prohibited and is itself a violation of this Code subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

8. Enforcement & Consequences

Violations of this Code may result in disciplinary action commensurate with the severity of the violation, including verbal or written warning, performance improvement plan, suspension, demotion, or termination of employment. Certain violations may also be referred to law enforcement authorities. The

severity of consequences will be determined by the Ethics & Compliance Committee in consultation with Human Resources and Legal.

9. Annual Acknowledgment

All employees are required to review this Code annually and sign the Annual Ethics Acknowledgment Form (CON-HR-001A) by February 15 of each year. New hires must complete acknowledgment within their first 10 business days. Completion is tracked by Human Resources and non-completion may result in restricted system access.